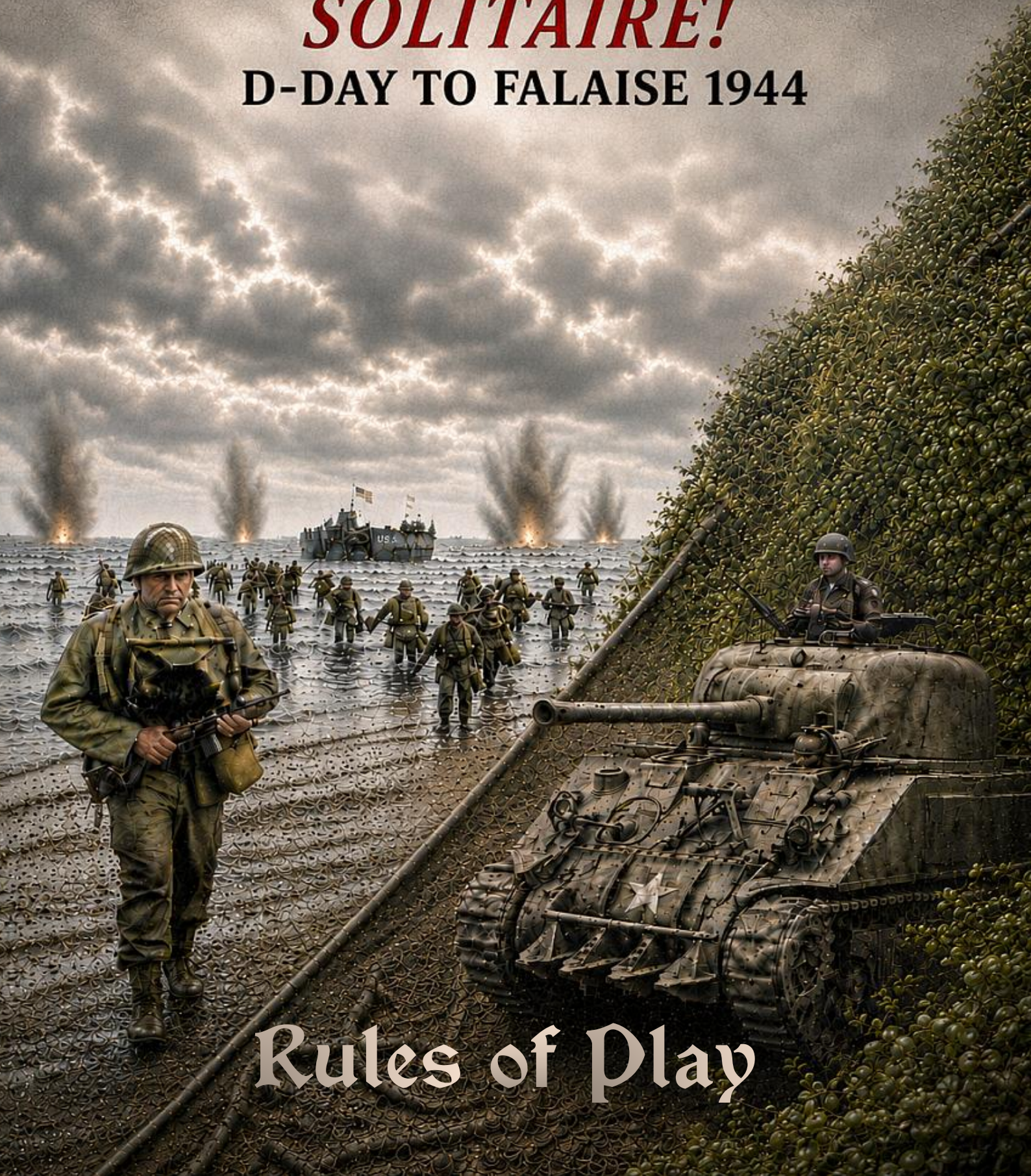


NORMANDY

SOLITAIRE!

D-DAY TO FALAISE 1944



Rules of Play

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INTRODUCTION

Normandy: Solitaire! is the first volume in an intended sequence of games, *States of Siege™: Operational Series*. It is a solitaire game telling the story of the 1944 Normandy Campaign through its key events and decision points. The game begins with the D-Day invasion and proceeds as you, the German commander, attempt to stop the advance of four Allied Armies; all are bent on destroying the German Army in Normandy and thus liberating occupied France.

Historical Event Cards dictate the movement of the Allied armies and give the player a number of Actions to conduct each turn. The game is played through three chronological Event decks, and if you can hold the Falaise Gap space through to the end of the third deck you win!

GAME EQUIPMENT

Parts Inventory

- 1 Game Map
- 80 game pieces including various markers (Strength modifiers, Siege markers, Fortified Villages markers, Resource markers)
- 48 Event cards (24 grey, 12 blue, and 12 green)
- 1 Rules booklet
- 1 Playbook
- 1 Player Aid Card
- 1 six-sided Die

The Game Map

WEATHER

Die Roll	Effect
1	Overcast - No ground or air support allowed
2-3	Partly Cloudy - 1/2 ground or air support allowed
4-6	Clear - All support allowed

CARPET BOMBING

Die Roll	Effect
1-4	No bombing, no carpet bombing
5	Area 18 carpet bombing
6	Area 18 carpet bombing

SIEGE TABLE

Die Roll	Effect
1	No effect
2	1/2 strength modifier
3	1/2 strength modifier
4	1/2 strength modifier
5	1/2 strength modifier
6	1/2 strength modifier

US 3rd ARMY ACTIVATION

At Start	Valognes	Cherbourg	Saint-Lô	Coutances	Avranches	Mortain
0	0	+1	+2	+3	+5	Auto

SEQUENCE OF PLAY

- Draw Event Card
- Resources Phase
- Weather/Air Power Phase
- Allied Advances Phase
- Action Phase
 - Launch Counter-Attack
 - Move Panzer Divisions to form Strategic Reserve
 - Deploy Reinforcements to Map
 - Move Combat Unit One Space
 - Right Combat Units
 - Increase Resources
 - Fortify Villages (3)
 - Move Actions to Reserve Box
- Housekeeping Phase

MAP KEY

Symbol	Terrain Value
B	Bocage 2/1
T	Town 1
H	Hill 2
Beach	Beach 2
F	Fortress 4
Fortified Villages	Fortified Villages +1/+2
Falaise Gap	Falaise Gap 1

Transport

6
5
4
3
2
1
0

Supply

6
5
4
3
2
1
0

Hitler Approval

6
5
4
3
2
1
0
-1
REMOVED FROM COMMAND

Text in shaded boxes, like this, provide Designer's Notes explaining the rationale for a particular rule or mechanic.

The game map depicts the area of Normandy, plus a box representing those parts of Brittany, in which fighting occurred. The *Falaise Gap* space is the central hub of the game's activity and four coloured tracks emanate out from it.

Map Spaces

The spaces with "B" as a code represent bocage (hedgerow) country while spaces with "F" represent fortresses. "T" is for town spaces.

The two beach spaces, marked with "Beach", off the coast represent the five D-Day beaches: Utah, Omaha, Gold, Juno and Sword. They have been combined into two spaces; one where the American armies landed; the other where the British-Canadian armies invaded.

The beach spaces can only be counter-attacked on Turns 1 and 2.

Spaces with "H" are hill spaces.

There are also various charts, and boxes for "In Transit" and "Strategic Reserve" units, a map key and three Resource Tracks for Transport, Supply and Hitler Approval.

Fortress spaces can never be attacked by the Player, i.e., once Caen, Brest and Lorient fall to the Allies they stay Allied controlled for the rest of the game.

Some spaces have icons at top right corner, *Loss of Hitler Approval* and *Possible US 3rd Army Activation* (see below).

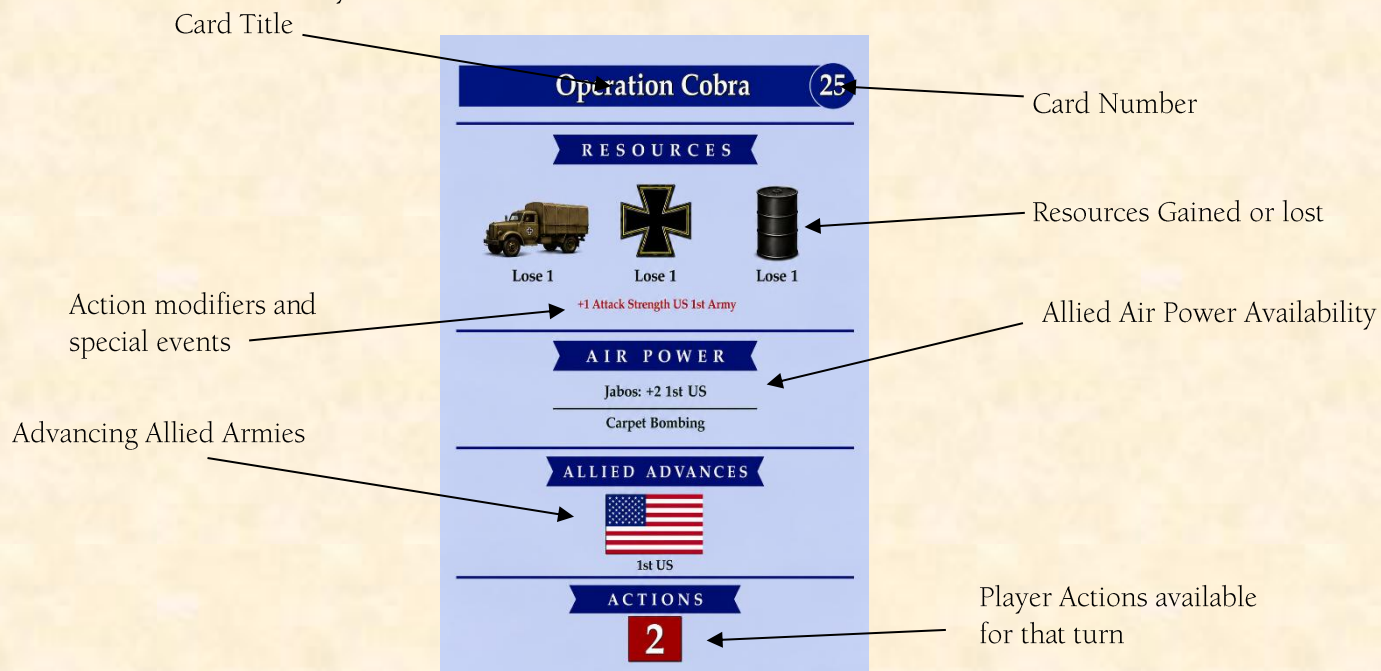


Unlike most other games in the *States of Siege* series, all map spaces have an inherent defensive value (called *Terrain Value*). See the terrain key on the map

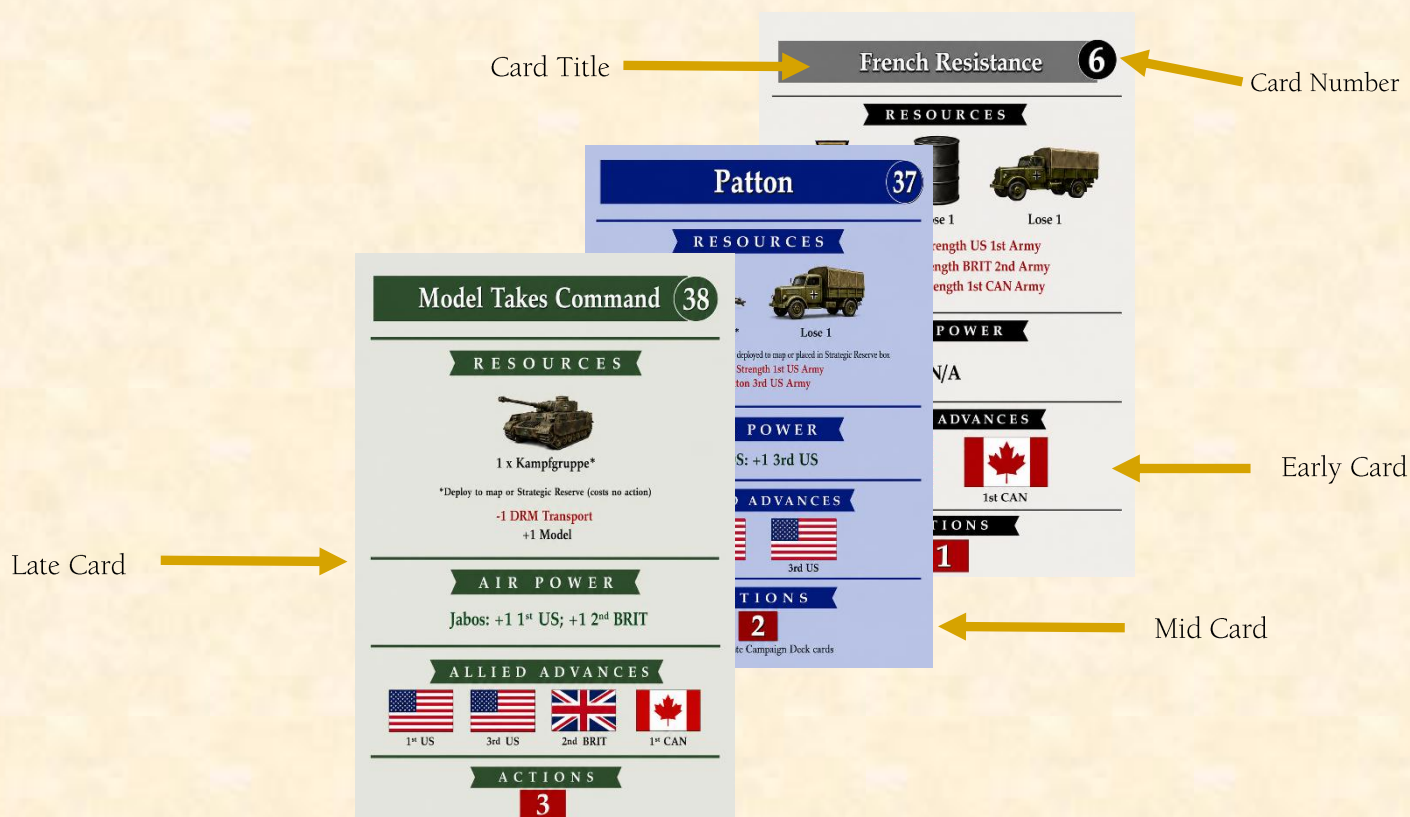
The Four Boxes with Army designations are the starting points for those armies. Note that at the start of the game, British 1 Corps uses the 1st Canadian Army track (until the Canadian Army is activated by an event).

Event Cards

There are three decks of Event Cards indicated by the background color of the headline at the top: grey, blue and green. These cards reveal the game's narrative and drive the enemy forces against the player, also giving the number of Actions available to the Player, listing available Allied air power, German reinforcements and resource level changes. The historical narrative for each card is listed in the Playbook.



Unlike many SoS games, historical text does not appear on the card (to save space). The card descriptions can be found in the Playbook.



WEATHER	
Die Roll	Effects
1	Overcast – No air power available +1 DRM for Supply, Transport Resource Rolls.
2–3	Partly Clear – 1 Jabo available; +1 DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable)
4–6	Clear – all Jabos available; No DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable)

CARPET BOMBING	
Die Roll	Effects
1–4	No Effect: Use +2 Carpet Bombing
5	Use – 1 Carpet Bombing
6	Attack cancelled

SIEGE TABLE	
Die Roll	Effects
1	No Effect
2	Eliminate 1 combat Step
3	Eliminate 2 combat Steps
4–5	Eliminate 3 combat Steps
6	Space Captured

DRMs:

- -1 if defense-attack differential is >= 6
- -2 if defense-attack differential is >= 10
- -1 if no air power
- +1 if no combat steps in fortress

US 3rd ARMY ACTIVITIES			
At Start	Cherbourg	Saint-Lô	Coutances
0	+1	+2	+3

Roll 2D6 + DRM ≥ 12 → US 3rd Army

IN TRANSIT

✠

STRATEGIC RESERVE

✠

ELIMINATED UNITS

✠

2 U.S. 3rd Army
Starts St. Malo/Rennes

BRITTANY

US VIII Corps Only

US VIII Corps
St Malo (T, 7)

US XV Corps
Rennes (T, 4)

Avranches (B, 4)

Mortain (B, 3)

Vire (T, 2)

Coutances (B, 5)

Saint-Lô (B, 6)

Carentan (B, 9)

Valognes (B, 8)

Utah/Omaha Beach (10)

Cherbourg (T, 7)

U.S. 1st Army



ATION

Avranches	Mortain
+5	Auto

Activates



NORMANDY

SOLITAIRE!

D-DAY TO FALAISE 1944



SEQUENCE OF PLAY

Draw Event Card

Resources Phase

Weather/Air Power Phase

Allied Advances Phase

Action Phase

- Launch Counter-Attack
- Move Panzer Divisions to/from Strategic Reserve
- Deploy Reinforcements to Map
- Redeploy Combat Units
- Refit Combat Units
- Increase Resources
- Fortify Villages (3)
- Move Actions to Reserve Box

Housekeeping Phase

MAP KEY

Terrain Value

	B Bocage	2/1
	T Town	1
	H Hill	2
	Beach	2
	F Fortress	4
	Fortified Villages	+1/+2
	Falaise Gap	1



6

5

4

3

2

1

0

Transport



6

5

4

3

2

1

0

Supply



6

5

4

3

2

1

0

-1

REMOVED
FROM COMMAND

Hitler
Approval

SETTING UP THE GAME

Follow these steps to set up the game:

1. Place each of the three invading Allied Army units on their starting boxes (1st US Army; 2nd British Army (XXX Corps side); 1st Canadian Army (I Corps side).
2. Place the US VIII and US XV Corps and the US 3rd Army markers in the 3rd US Army starting box next to St Malo. This army is inactive at the start of the game.

1st US Army begins the game with its “3” side face up; the two British-Canadian Corps begin the game on their “2” side. The two US 3rd Army Corps are “2” strength corps.
3. 21st Panzer, two Nebelwerfer and one 88mm FlaK Unit begin in Bayeux
4. Two Nebelwerfer and one 88mm Flak Unit begin in Lebissey Wood
5. One 88mm Flak Unit begins in Carentan
6. Place the German resource markers as follows:
 - Place the Transport marker on the 5 box of the “Transport” track
 - Place the Hitler Approval marker on the 6 box of the “Hitler Approval” track
 - Place the Supply marker on the 4 box of the “Supply” track
7. Place the US 3rd Army Activation marker on the 0 space of the US 3rd Army Activation track.
8. Sort the cards into their three epochs (Early, Mid, Late). Set aside the Mid and Late decks for now.
9. Place all the other markers to the side of the board

Counters

The cardboard game pieces represent the four invading Allied Armies, one marker for each of the three resource tracks (Transport, Supply and Hitler Approval), and markers representing various military units (Allied fighter-bombers [*Jabos*], *Carpet Bombing* markers and pieces representing various German formations involved in the Normandy campaign.

There are also pieces representing *Nebelwerfers* (German rocket artillery) and *FlaK 88mm* anti-tank guns, *Siege* markers, *Fortified Villages* markers, and markers for *Patton*, *Montgomery* and *Model*.

There also DRM (Die Roll Modifier) and Attack/Defense Strength Modifier markers which remind the player when DRMs should be applied to die rolls or modifiers applied to attacking or defending forces in battles.

Allied Armies



The armies represent the forces arrayed against the German army in Normandy. Armies start with a weaker “2” or “3” defense strength, but are flipped to their stronger “4” sides by Card 28 *Upgrade Armies*.

US 3rd Army starts with its defense strength at “4”, but is broken down into its two corps; VIII and XV corps, as VIII Corps is diverted to Brittany. So the US 3rd Army marker is not deployed to the map when it activates; it will only do so if and when the two corps occupy the same space.

The British 2nd Army is initially represented by its two component corps, XXX Corps and I Corps (both defense strength 2). When the *Upgrade Armies* (Card #28) is played, XXX Corps is flipped to become British 2nd Army and I Corps is flipped to become 1st Canadian Army as shown here:





The First Canadian Army was activated on July 23rd; up to that point Canadian formations served under British command (1st Corps in British 2nd Army). To reflect this, initially the two attacking British-Canadian formations are XXX Corps and I Corps, even though the tracks are marked British 2nd Army and 1st Canadian Army. Note the Canadian Flag is not the actual one that was in use in 1944. This one is used for ease of game play purposes (i.e., familiarity)

Resource Track Markers

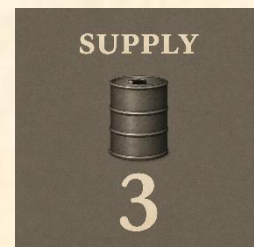
Transport



Hitler Approval



Supply



The three resource markers have a Base Level on their front. Transport and Supply Base Levels do not change but Hitler Approval Base Level changes to 4 following draw of Card #27 *Hitler Assassination*. This is the number the player needs to roll higher than to increase that resource's level on its respective track. This is called an **Augmentation Roll**.

Various game functions require rolling less than or equal to the current resource level appropriate for that function. This is called a **Resource Check**. For example, rolling to allow a Panzer division to redeploy from the map to the Strategic Reserve box, requires passing a Transport Check.

German units are considered to be abstractly present in every space on the board by the space's terrain value, but these forces can be augmented by panzer units, nebelwerfers and FlaK anti-tank units.

Once German panzer divisions take a loss in combat they are flipped to their reverse side; the next time they lose a strength point in combat they are eliminated.

Reduced (+1) panzer divisions can be withdrawn to the Strategic Reserve Box to be refitted (restored to full strength).

Panzer Units



Note that SS Panzer Divisions have black counters; Wehrmacht Panzer Divisions have blue counters. For example, below is 2nd Panzer division. This has no effect on gameplay.

Additionally, there are several “Kampfgruppen” (ad hoc battle groups) which come into play via event card later in the game.



Other German Combat Markers

Nebelwerfer



flaK 88 mm Anti-Tank



101st Tiger Battalion



Nebelwerfer units are eliminated if they take a loss.

Flak 88 units begin at +2 (Full Strength) and are flipped to +1 (Reduced Strength) when they take a loss. A further loss eliminates the unit.

These units provide a Defense Strength Modifier when present in a space being attacked by an Allied Army. Panzer units and Nebelwerfer units also provide an Attack Strength Modifier when attacking Allied Armies.

Michael Wittmann's 101st Tiger Battalion provides a one-off +3 Attack Strength Modifier when activated by the appropriate event card and is then removed from play (event card 9 *Michael Wittmann*)

Commanders

There are three commanders in the game, which are activated by event-card and provide Strength Modifiers (for that turn) for the units stipulated on the cards (Allies) or any German space in the case of Model.

Note that Model cannot be deployed until Card #38 *Model Takes Command* is drawn. If a card specifies Model as a resource for the player before that card has been drawn, ignore that reference.

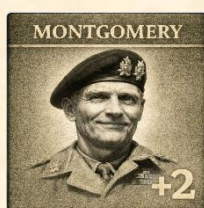
All Commanders' modifiers apply on defense **and** attack.

Model is allocated to any German-held space (except one under Siege) at any point in the turn; Player's choice.

Patton



Montgomery



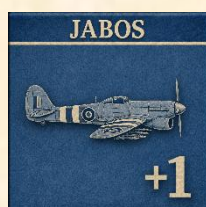
Model



Allied Air Power Markers

Markers representing Allied Fighter Bombers ("Jabos") and Heavy Bombers used in a tactical role ("Carpet Bombing"). Each is deployed via Event Card and provides an Attack **and** Defense Strength modifier (in the case of Jabos), and an Attack Strength Modifier (in the case of Carpet Bombing), but is dependent on weather:

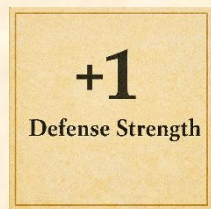
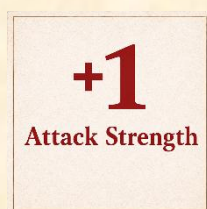
Jabos



Carpet Bombing



Other Markers



Attack and Defense Strength Modifier markers are used as a reminder of modifiers listed on the event cards. The Resource DRM markers are used as reminders for DRMs (listed on event cards) to the Resource Checks; Augmentation Roll DRMs apply in Overcast Weather turns.

SEQUENCE OF PLAY

The full deck of cards enters play in three “epochs”: Grey - Early (Cards #1-24), Blue- Mid (#25-36) and Yellow - Late (#37-48)

Cards #1 and #2 are always the first two cards played at the start of every game.

Remove cards 1 and 2 and play those as the first two cards of the game. Then draw a card randomly for each subsequent turn.

The Mid and Late decks are shuffled in when the appropriate event card is revealed.

The sequence of play is as follows: -

1. **Event Phase.** Reveal the top card in the draw deck and place it, face up, on the discard pile. That card becomes the new Current Event Card that you must resolve that turn.
2. **Weather/Air Power Phase.** Roll on the weather table to determine the weather; this will decide how much air power is available to the Allies and whether there are any DRMs on Supply/Transport Augmentation Rolls. Note, no weather roll is made when card #13 *The Great Storm* is drawn (weather is automatically overcast). Roll on Carpet Bombing table if required (i.e., when Carpet Bombing is listed on the card and the weather is not overcast)
3. **Resources Phase.** Place Jabos, Carpet Bombing, DRM/strength modifier markers. Adjust Changes to Resource Tracks. Add reinforcements to In Transit or Strategic Resource box.
4. **Military Phase.** Move all active Allied armies as indicated on the Event Card. If any Allied Army advances into the Falaise Gap (0) space, you immediately lose the game. Resolve combat between the advancing armies using the terrain value of the space being moved into plus strength modifiers for defending German units.
5. **Action Phase.** The Current Event Card confers a number of Actions to the player. These are used to: -
 - Launch counter-attacks against Allied Armies to push them back
 - Deploy Reinforcements from the In Transit box to the Strategic Reserve box and from the Strategic Reserve box to the map
 - Redeploy Panzer units to the Strategic Reserve box
 - Refit reduced Panzer Divisions (bring to full strength) residing in the Strategic Reserve box
 - Attempt to increase the resources on the resource tracks
 - Place a *Fortified Villages* marker (costs 3 Actions)
 - Put 1 or 2 Actions into the Strategic Reserve Box
6. **Housekeeping Phase:** Remove all JABO, Carpet Bombing and DRM markers from the map.

A complete game continues until all the cards from all three decks have been revealed and played

D-Day Landings

The first two Event Cards of the Early Deck are the two D-Day landings cards. For card 1, roll a die for each of the three invading armies. If the result is GREATER THAN (>) 1, the British and Canadians successfully land on the Gold-Juno-Sword space (roll separately for each army).

If the result is GREATER THAN (>) 2, the US First Army successfully lands on Utah-Omaha

Omaha-Utah tended to have stronger beach defenses than those in the British-Canadian sector, hence the higher terrain value. Although at the seafront Utah beach's defenses were not as strong as at Omaha, it had strong defenses inland (within a mile of the beach).

If an Allied Army lands on a beach on turn 1, the Germans get one opportunity to push that army back to its offshore box, after which it will re-land automatically on turn two and is then deemed to have a permanent lodgement.

Note that for German counter-attacks on turns 1 and 2, the Terrain Value of the beach spaces is 2 for both Beach spaces.

The player, on Turn 1, with his one Action on turn 1 could:

Launch an attack against British 2nd Army from Bayeux, or against 1 Corps from Lebissey Woods.

Launch an attack against US 1st Army from Carentan. Beach boxes have a terrain value of 2 when attacked.

Note that the player only gets one Action on turn 1 so may not wish to make any attacks, since reinforcements are due to arrive.

RESOURCES PHASE

When each card is drawn, conduct the following:



- If the weather is overcast, place +1 DRM *Augmentation Roll* markers on the Transport and Supply tracks



- Place -1 or +1 DRM *Resource Check* markers on the Resource Tracks as listed on the Event Card
- Place Attack/Defense Strength modifiers for the Allied Armies as listed on the Event Card
- Place Commander markers deployed to the correct space as listed on the Event Card
- Place German Reinforcements in the *In Transit* (Panzer Divisions) or *Strategic Reserves* boxes or on the map (all others).
- Adjust Resource Levels according to the Event Card

If the Player launches an attack against a beach box containing two units (1 British and 1 Canadian) he only attacks the Army on the track where the attackers reside, and only that army is pushed back to the start box in the event the player wins the battle.

Example 1

The Player rolls a 3 (success) for 1st US Army and places the army marker in the Utah/Omaha beach box. He rolls a 2 (success) for the British 2nd Army and 1 (failure) for 1st Canadian Army. British XXX Corps marker is placed on the Gold-Juno-Sword space; British I Corps marker stays in the 1st Canadian Army Start Box.

Now the German player decides to use his one Action to counter-attack the beachhead. He decides to use the *Nebelwerfer* unit in Carentan: Defense Strength of 5 (2 for Terrain Value of beach plus 3 for US 1st Army). Attack Strength is 1 for the *Nebelwerfer*.

He needs to roll a 5 or 6. He rolls a 5 so the US 1st Army is forced back to its Starting Box. The *Nebelwerfer* remains in Carentan (no advances to beach spaces).

On turn 2, the US 1st Army advances to the Utah/Omaha beach box without needing a die roll.

Note that if the Player had not counter-attacked successfully, the US 1st Army Advance listed on Card 2 would have meant it attacked Carentan.

i.e., any armies which fail to land on turn 1, automatically land on turn 2.

Example 2

Both XXX Corps and I Corps have successfully landed at Gold-Juno-Sword beach. On his turn the player decides to launch a counter attack from Bayeux against XXX Corps. Defense Strength is 3 + 2 for the beach (total 5). The Germans use 21st Panzer and two *Nebelwerfer* units for a total Attack Strength of 4. Any roll other than 1 will succeed.

The Player wins the battle and British XXX Corps moves back to its Start Box. I Corps remains in the beach box. The German forces take no losses and remain in Bayeux.

On turn 2 the British XXX Corps advances to the Gold-Juno-Sword beach box without needing a roll.

Given the initial disposition of German formations, it would have been virtually impossible to throw all three Allied armies back in to the sea. Although see Optional Rule 1 which has two additional panzer divisions close to the coast to explore this option.

WEATHER / AIR POWER PHASE

The Allied Air Power available on a given turn is dependent on the weather.

The weather is determined during the Weather Phase according to the following table:

The effect of Allied Air Power on the interdiction of supplies and reinforcements was a major factor in the outcome of the Normandy campaign. This has been abstracted into the various losses of resources on the cards.

WEATHER	
Die Roll	Effects
1	Overcast – No air power available +1 DRM for Supply, Transport Resource Rolls.
2–3	Partly Clear – 1 Jabo available; +1 DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable)
4–6	Clear – all Jabos available; No DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable)

Overcast weather gives +1 DRM on Transport/Supply Augmentation Rolls for this turn; see *Augmentation Rolls*.

When Carpet Bombing is listed as an air asset, roll once on the Carpet Bombing table. The result applies to each Allied Army listed on the card to advance regardless of how many Jabo markers it receives (which means sometimes an Army will get a modifier from Carpet Bombing but not a Jabo). **Exception: Carpet Bombing markers are never placed on US Third Army or its two corps.**

"Jabo" was a colloquial German term for fighter-bomber aircraft, derived from the word *Jagdbomber*. In Normandy, Allied fighter-bombers like the P-47 Thunderbolt and Typhoon completely dominated the skies, destroying German armor, halting troop movements, and making daylight travel almost impossible

The carpet bombing table will determine if the carpet bombing has any negative effect on the attack due to "creep back" (friendly fire). Carpet bombing is allocated to each army listed on the Military section of the card. Some event cards do not have Carpet Bombing attacks so this rule will often be redundant.

CARPET BOMBING	
Die Roll	Effects
1–4	No Effect: Use +2 Carpet Bombing
5	Use +1 Carpet Bombing
6	Attack cancelled

Note Allied air power is only used for close air support of ground attacks; it is not used to defend armies against attack.

The Carpet bombing table, i.e., the use of strategic air assets for operational objectives in support of ground forces, reflects the ambivalently view held by ground forces, due to the nigh-inevitable friendly casualties caused by bombers dropping their ordnance short of the aiming point, either through error or "bomb creep". A roll of 6 represents this.

Example



Card 18 Operation Charnwood is drawn. The weather roll is "3" so 1 Jabo is available.

This is allocated to the first Army listed in the Air Power section (1st Canadian Army) and there is a +1 DRM on the Carpet Bombing table.

A "4" is rolled, modified to 5, so a +1 Carpet Bombing marker is allocated to each of the two Armies listed on the Event Card.

ALLIED ADVANCES PHASE

During the Allied Advances Phase, the current Event card specifies which Armies must be moved along their respective tracks. Generally, these armies move a single box closer to the Falaise Gap (i.e., to the next consecutively lowered box). Occasionally, armies will retreat one space (i.e., further away from the Falaise Gap); usually as a result of a successful German attack.

The US Third Army begins the game inactive; it is activated automatically when the player rolls 2d6 $\geq$ 12, using the DRMs listed in the US 3rd Army Activation table. See *US 3rd Army Activation*

Unlike many other States of Siege™ games, each and every space on the map has an inherent defensive Terrain Value. These are listed on the game board Map Key. For example, bocage “B” spaces have a terrain value of two, although this reduces to one (for German defenders) when the *Sherman “Rhino”* Event Card is played.

Additionally, the intrinsic Terrain Value of the spaces can be augmented by the placement of German combat units: Panzer divisions, *Kampfgruppen*, *Nebelwerfer* units, and *FlaK 88mm* anti-tank units. These units add a further Strength Modifier to the base Terrain Value.

The Terrain Values are as follows:

- [2] Beaches
- [1] Towns
- [2, later 1 for Allied attacks] Bocage
- [2] Hills
- [4] Fortresses: Caen/Brest/Lorient
- [+1] Fortified Villages created by player
- [1] Falaise Gap

Allied Army Attacks

When an Allied unit is to advance into a space, carry out the following procedure.

1. Start with the Terrain Value of the space. Add the Defense Strength of any defending German units.
2. Total all Attack Strength modifiers of the attacking Allied army. These could be modifiers from cards, or modifiers from counters (Commanders, JABOS, Carpet Bombing).
3. Calculate the Attack Strength as the sum of the above two values
4. Roll the die. If the die roll plus the Attack Strength is GREATER THAN ($>$) the Defense Strength, the advance has succeeded and the Allied unit moves in to the defending space.

If on the other hand the modified die roll is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO ($\leq$) the Defense Strength, the advancing unit is halted and simply remains in its current space; it does not advance.

Example

On Turn 3, the event card drawn is #14 *Operation Epsom*. The weather is overcast. The military section shows advances by 2nd British and 1st Canadian army so 2nd British will attack Bayeux (space 5 on the British 2nd Army track is a town with a Terrain Value of 1).

The Air Power section lists Jabos and Carpet Bombing but since the weather is overcast these are not available this turn.

Where the card says +1 Attack Strength 2nd BRIT, this means an additional +1 to the overall Attack Strength

Bayeux contains 21st Panzer (+2) plus two Nebelwerfer rocket units (+2) and one reduced strength Flak 88 (+1) giving a Defense Strength modifier of **+5**.

Attack Strength = **3** (+1 Attack Strength modifier listed on card, +2 Montgomery)

Defense Strength = **6** (1 for Bayeux plus 5 modifiers)

Allied Army must roll GREATER THAN Defense Strength [6] to advance, with 3 v 6 this becomes a 4 or higher.

Now the player rolls a 4

Final Attack Strength is 7. So, the Allies advance. German player takes one loss and retreats the remainder of his units one space to Tilly.

Note that a 1 always fails and a 6 always succeeds (exception; 6 does not automatically succeed for Fortresses).

If the Attack Strength is <= Defense Strength → the attack **fails**, German defenders must still take 1 loss (there is no advance)

If the Attack Strength > Defense Strength – Attack **succeeds**, German defenders must take 1 loss and retreat to next space on track. Allied Army advances into the attacked space.

See example:



British XXX Corps attacks 21st Panzer in Bayeux

Even if the German defenders hold off the Allied Advance, they still must take a loss. This simulates the gradual attrition and loss of combat cohesion of the German forces in Normandy.

German Defensive Units

There are four types of German defensive units which can appear on the board defending German controlled spaces: Panzer Divisions, *kampfgruppen*, Nebelwerfer Rocket Artillery and FlaK 88mm anti-tank gun units.

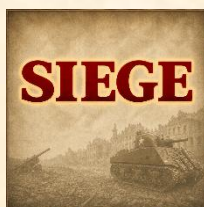
All these units appear as reinforcements on the Event Cards (other than the forces which start on the map).

If German units successfully defend a space, they will always take 1 strength loss. The loss can be taken by eliminating a Nebelwerfer or Kampfgruppe Unit, or by reducing a Panzer Division or FlaK 88 Unit from +2 to +1, or by eliminating a +1 Panzer Division/FlaK 88 Unit.

If the German forces lose the combat and the Allied army advances in to that space, after taking a loss, all German units retreat one space.

The 101st Tiger Battalion represents Michael Wittman's formation and can be used as a one-off unit, either defending or attacking. Once involved in any combat it is removed from the game.

Sieges



If the difference between the total Defensive Strength of a force in the Caen, Lorient or Brest Fortress spaces and the Allied Army Attack Strength is 6 or more, then a Siege is declared. Place a Siege marker in that fortress space.

Counter-attacks by German forces into Allied held Fortress spaces are not allowed.

Once Fortress towns such as Caen, Brest or Lorient were taken, there was no realistic prospect they could ever be recaptured. This rule prevents lucky low-odds attacks resulting in a Fortress being recaptured which would then allow the defender to pile it up with another mass defense which is completely ahistorical. In the game, Cherbourg is not a Fortress since historically it only lasted a week or so once besieged.

A new Siege is declared each time the Fortress is attacked by an Allied Army; for example, if the Germans recapture Lebiey Wood and then the Allies retake that space and attack Caen a new Siege *may* occur (depending on the relative Attack and Defense Strengths). See Siege Table:

SIEGE TABLE	
Die Roll	Effects
1	No Effect
2	Eliminate 1 combat Step
3	Eliminate 2 combat Steps
4-5	Eliminate 3 combat Steps
6	Space Captured
DRMs: • -1 if defense-attack differential is ≥ 6 • -2 if defense-attack differential is ≥ 10 • -1 if no air power • +1 if no combat steps in fortress	

If a modified 6 is rolled, all units in the fortress are eliminated and the Siege is over. Advance the Allied Army (or US VIII Corps) into the Fortress space. Remove the Siege marker: Hitler approval is reduced by 2 for loss of Brest and Lorient, 1 for Caen.

Example (see diagram)

The Defense Strength is 4 (Fortress) + 4 (Panzer Units) + 2 (Nebelwerfers) + 2 (Flak 88) = 12

Since the Allies cannot win this (Defense Strength – Attack Strength is 10), a siege is declared. A Siege marker is placed in the Caen space.

The image shows a tactical map from the board game 'The Battle of Normandy'. A red dashed arrow points from a stack of cards at Lebiesey to a stack of cards at Caen. The Lebiesey stack includes a 'Lebiesey' card, a 'BRITISH I CORPS' card with a Union Jack, a '+1' card, and a '5' card. The Caen stack includes a 'Nebelwerfer' card, a '2nd SS PANZER' card, a 'Nebelwerfer' card, an '88mm FLAK' card, a '116th PANZER' card, and a 'SIEGE' card. A red cross symbol is also visible. The map background shows a coastline with a river and a city.

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PLAYER ACTIONS PHASE

During the Player Actions Phase, the player may carry out one or more activities by spending the number of Actions allocated to him on the Event Card. The cost of each possible activities is listed on the Turn Sequence table and on the Player Aid Card.

Deploy Reinforcements

The first thing the Player should do at the beginning of the Player Actions Phase is determine which, if any, of the *In Transit* Panzer Divisions arrive successfully in the Strategic Reserve.

Any [Panzer Division] reinforcements due must make a Transport Check (i.e., roll against the current Transport level). If the roll is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO ($\leq$) the Transport level, the reinforcements reach Normandy and move in to the Strategic Reserve box where they await being released for deployment by Hitler. **This roll (the Transport Check) does not cost an Action.**

Kampfgruppen/Nebelwerfer/Flak 88 Units move directly to either the map or Strategic Reserve box. This costs no Action and no rolls are needed; some or all of these units can be moved to the map at any time during the turn (including after all Player Actions are completed).

If the Transport Check fails, the Panzer Division reinforcements remain in the In Transit box. Repeat the Transport Check **once per turn** at the beginning of each Player Actions Phase for each division in the In Transit box.

During the Normandy campaign, Hitler maintained strict control over the release and deployment of the Panzer divisions; hence in the game, the player must pass a Hitler Approval roll in order to deploy Panzer Divisions from the Strategic Reserve.

Example



Card 5 *Panzer Meyer* is drawn. 2nd Panzer division is listed as reinforcement. The current Transport level is 5. For this formation, a roll of less than or equal to ($\leq$) 5 will move the unit into the Strategic Reserve box. This roll does not cost an Action.

Once in the Strategic Reserve box, in order to now deploy this unit on to the map, the player would have to spend an Action to roll for Hitler Approval (currently 5). So this would require a roll of less than or equal to ($\leq$) 5 to allow the unit to be deployed to the map.

Note that units in the *In Transit* box which pass the Transport Check and have moved to the Strategic Reserve Box can be deployed to the map for one Action (as described above) or they can be left in the Strategic Reserve Box for future deployment.

When deploying to the map, reinforcements can be placed in any German-controlled space, i.e. not in or behind the Allied Armies on their tracks, subject to stacking limits.

Redeploy Panzer Divisions (1 Action)

For a cost of one Action, the player may move a Panzer Division from the Strategic Reserve to any German-controlled space on the map (except spaces under Siege), subject to stacking limits. A Hitler Approval Check must be passed.

For a cost of one Action, the player may move a Panzer Division from the map to the Strategic Reserve. A Transport Check must be passed.

Once Panzer formations are deployed to any German controlled space the stacking limit must be adhered to. The stacking limit is 4 panzer formations, 3 *Nebelwerfer*, and 3 88mm *FlaK* units per space. *Kampfgruppen* and 101st Heavy Battalion count as a panzer division for stacking purposes.

Panzer Divisions must be redeployed via the Strategic Reserve box. *Kampfgruppen*, *Nebelwerfer* and *Flak88* units can never be redeployed. **Exception:** *Kampfgruppen* can be redeployed by *Hitler Intervention* Event Cards.

Units in a Fortress space under siege may not be redeployed out of that space while the siege continues, nor may units be deployed into the Siege space.

Hitler's strict control of the Panzer units also extended to interference in their operational, and even tactical, deployment on occasion. A loss would enrage Hitler as he often accused Generals of misusing these valuable assets.

Refit Panzer Units (1 Action)

At a cost of one Action, Panzer Divisions can be refitted. Refit allows reduced strength (+1) Panzer Divisions to be restored to full strength (+2); this does not apply to *kampfgruppen*. Flip the Panzer Division from its +1 side to its +2 side.

Move Any Single Unit One Space (1 Action)

For one Action, any unit on the map can move to an adjacent space. This does not require a Transport Check. For example this allows *Flak88* units "left behind" (because they cannot attack) when Germans counter attack to "catch up", or units to retreat one space.

Units in a Fortress space under siege may not move into or out of the besieged space.

Conduct Augmentation Roll (1 Action)

At a cost of one Action, the player may attempt to improve the level of any of his three resources by making an *Augmentation Roll*.

If the weather is overcast (automatic when Card #13 *The Great Storm* is drawn), there is a +1 DRM to Transport and Supply Augmentation Rolls. These are the only DRMs that ever apply to Augmentation Rolls.

All the DRMs listed on the cards apply to Resource Checks, not Augmentation Rolls

Example

The player's current Supply Resource Level is 1 and his Supply Base Level is "3" (as shown on the Supply counter). The weather is clear (so no +1 DRM). A die roll GREATER THAN (>) 3 will result in the Supply level increasing to 2.

If the weather is overcast (+1 DRM), a roll > 2 will result in supply level increasing by 1.

As many augmentation rolls may be made as desired per turn, subject to the number of Actions available.

To a large degree, the ability of the German forces in France to move reinforcements and supplies within and to Normandy was affected by the availability of Allied Air Power. This rule reflects that. When the Allied aircraft were grounded due to adverse weather it was far easier to reinforce/move/supply the formations in Normandy.

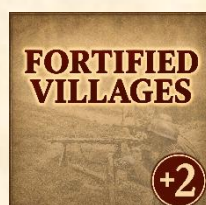
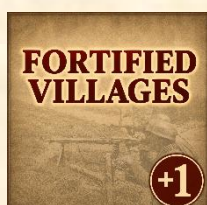
Place Fortified Villages Marker (3 Actions)

For a cost of 3 Actions, the player may fortify any space under German control (except the Falaise Gap space and Fortress spaces). The space becomes a *Fortified Villages* space (place the Fortified Villages +1 marker on the space) with a defense value of one higher than the underlying Terrain Value, so a Town space becomes 2, for example, and remains so until captured by an Allied Army.

Sieges never apply to Fortified Villages. If the bocage Terrain Value decreases to 1 due to the *Sherman Rhino* event, the marker adds +1 to the reduced value (so Terrain Value becomes 2).

For a further 3 Actions, he may upgrade the *Fortified Villages* from +1 to +2 which adds 2 to the underlying Terrain Value. Flip the marker over to its +2 side.

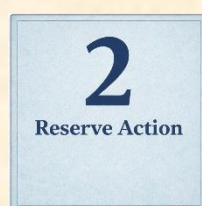
If a Fortified Village space is lost, remove the marker. The space reverts to its base type/Terrain Value.



This rule represents the German ability to fortify Normandy villages and farms, transforming stone buildings and ancient enclosed farms into strongpoints.

Put Actions into Strategic Reserve Box (1 Action)

The player may move 1 or 2 Actions in the Strategic Reserve box for later use at a cost of 1 Action. There can only ever be a maximum of two Actions in the box. It costs one Action per action point moved to the SR Box. They can be used to "pay" the Action cost of other Actions when used later.



Conduct Counter-Attack (1 Action)

Any Allied Army may be attacked (except those in beach spaces from turn 3 onwards, and fortress spaces) whether or not there are German formations adjacent to the Allied Army space; the German units simply provide extra Attack Strength Modifiers and make the attack more likely to succeed.

The Player may attack with all, none or some of the combat units eligible to attack the adjacent space.

Prior to the attack, combat units may be moved to the attacked space from Strategic Reserve (which of course requires a Hitler Approval Check) or from an adjacent space, for a cost of 1 Action.

If the player attacks and wins, increase the Hitler Approval level by one.

ALLIED DEFENSE STRENGTH: Army Defense Rating + Terrain + Sum of all Defense Strength modifiers

GERMAN ATTACK STRENGTH: Sum of all Unit Attack Strengths + d6

IF GERMAN ATTACK STRENGTH > ALLIED DEFENSE STRENGTH

- ⇒ GERMAN ATTACKING UNITS ADVANCE, ALLIED ARMY RETREATS
- ⇒ HITLER APPROVAL UP 1

The cost is 1 Supply Point (total) if any Panzer units (incl. *kampfgruppen* and 101st Tiger Battalion) are involved in the attack.

Where German units are available, they add their Attack Strength Modifiers to the die roll for the attack. **Flak 88 units cannot attack.**

Where German formations involved in an attack fail to win a combat, take 1 loss: either one Panzer unit is flipped to its “1” side (or eliminated if already on the “1” side) or eliminate a *Nebelwerfer* unit. Attacks involving one or more panzer units cost 1 Supply point in total.

If the attack fails, German units remain in their space.

If it succeeds, **ALL** participating combat units must advance to the attacked space.

Allied Armies may only be attacked once per turn.

Example 1



The 3-Strength US 1st Army is in Carentan. The Player can attack from the adjacent space (Valognes).

With no German Attack Strength Modifiers, the Player would require a die roll GREATER THAN (>) **5** to cause the US Army to retreat (2 for the Bocage +3 for the Army).

Example 2



The 3-Strength US 1st Army is in Carentan. The 116th Panzer Division is in Valognes. A +1 (reduced) Panzer Lehr is in the Strategic Reserve box.

For one Action the Player attempts to redeploy Panzer Lehr from the Strategic Reserve box. He passes a Hitler Approval Check and moves Panzer Lehr to Valognes.

Now the Attack Strength Modifiers are +3 (+2 for 116th Panzer, +1 for Panzer Lehr). Defense Strength is 5 (as in Example 1). So, the Player is going to need a 3 or more.

The Player rolls a 1 (fails) and chooses to reduce 116th Panzer: both units remain in Valognes.

The Supply Points marker is moved down the Supply track by 1. Hitler Approval is unchanged. A defeat in a counter-attack does not affect Hitler Approval.

MISCELLANEOUS RULES

Supply

If the Supply level reaches 0, no attacks may be launched involving Panzer units until the supply level is increased to at least one. Other attacks (not involving Panzer units) are unaffected.

One Supply Point is deducted from the supply track where any panzer units are involved in an attack, including 101st Tiger Battalion and *kampfgruppen*

One of the key elements of the game is to occasionally attempt to force enemy Allied Armies to retreat.

In *Normandy: Solitaire!*, certain units can add their combat strength modifiers to the attack, namely Panzer units and Nebelwerfer units.

There is a cost in supply of one supply point per attack in any attack involving Panzer units, including *kampfgruppen*. It is not necessary to use German combat units in an attack; an Allied army can be attacked without such support, or the player can choose to attack with just nebelwerfer rocket units which cost no supply points.

If the player wins the combat, all of the participating panzer units/nebelwerfers must advance to the previously Allied occupied space.

If the player loses the combat, he suffers one a one step loss (of his choice).

Hitler Approval

Hitler Approval is increased by 1 for all successful attacks.

Hitler Approval is decreased by 1 for all unsuccessful defenses of a space where there are Panzer units (incl. *Kampfgruppen*) present.

Hitler Approval Checks are made for all “Hitler Intervention” event cards. If the roll is passed (the die roll is less than or equal to ($\leq$) the Hitler Approval level, the Player may choose to not execute the Hitler intervention (although he may choose to carry out the intervention if he wishes).

The player must pass a Hitler Approval Check in order to perform the following actions:

- Deploy a Panzer Division from/to the Strategic Reserve box
- Avoid having to carry out “Hitler Interventions” as defined by several Event Cards.

The player rolls a die; if the result is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO ($\leq$) the current Hitler Approval level the check has passed.

For “Hitler Intervention” cards, the player must fail the check for the intervention to go ahead, although he may choose to accept the intervention and not attempt the check. (Exception: the Card #32 *Mortain Counter Attack* always occurs; no check can be made).

For the “Mortain Counter Attack”, the start space (the Luttich space) is the space adjacent to US 1st Army. For this card, the attack is mandatory; the Player receives three additional Actions once the attack is complete.

In addition to Augmentation rolls by the Player and changes indicated on the cards, the Hitler Approval level rises by one for victorious attacks and is reduced by one for Panzer retreats.

Additionally, the Hitler approval level drops by one when Caen is lost and by two when Brest or Lorient are lost (so -4 for losing both Brittany ports).

In August 1944, Hitler ordered that Brest and Lorient be defended to the "last man and last bullet". The intent was to deny the Allies critical, deep-water port facilities to prevent them from supplying their armies.

US Third Army Activation

Each time the US First Army captures a space with a US Flag (for example Valognes), roll with 2d6 on the US Third Army Activation table using the DRM of the newly captured space. If the modified roll is GREATER THAN OR EQUAL TO ($\geq$) 12 immediately activate US 3rd Army by placing US VIII Corps in the St Malo space and US XV Corps in the Rennes space.

Only conduct one roll per space; i.e., if the US First Army captures one such space and then is forced to retreat, second and subsequent advances to that space do not trigger a US 3rd Army Activation roll. Record this by advancing the US 3rd Army Activation marker once position in the track each time such a space is captured. If the card has a US Third Army advance immediately conduct attacks for these two corps.

Brittany



US VIII and XV Corps Starting Locations

Historically Brest held out until late September, and Lorient until the end of the war.

When the US 3rd activates, its two corps begin in St Malo (VIII Corps) and Rennes (XIII Corps). When 3rd Army is listed to advance on a card, VIII Corps and XV Corps both advance.

VIII Corps attacks Brest and Lorient, XV Corps advances from Rennes. Each time a requirement to advance is shown on a card, advance **BOTH** corps. Any attack/defense/Air Power/Patton modifiers apply to both. If VIII Corps is required to advance into US held spaces, once it reaches Rennes onwards, no attack is necessary (i.e., it is moving up behind XV Corps).

If VIII Corps ever arrives in the same space as XV corps, merge them into a single US 3rd Army marker (strength 4).

Losing Brest or Lorient results in a -2 Hitler Approval Level (-2 for each Fortress) when these spaces are lost.

Hitler's attitude toward the fortress ports in Brittany was one of absolute, uncompromising, and defensive intransigence, driven by his directive to hold them "to the last man, to the last cartridge". That is reflected here in the harsh penalties to the Player if they are lost.

Ignore the Upgrade Armies event for 3rd Army. It is always a 4 strength Army, or two 2-strength corps.

Example



The Player draws Card #47 *Red Ball Express*.

US 1st Army advances to Avranches and rolls a modified 12 on the US 3rd Army Activation table, thus activating US 3rd Army.

VIII Corps and XV Corps are placed in the St. Malo and Rennes spaces respectively.



US VIII Corps immediately attacks Brest and XV Corps attacks Le Mans.



Event Card Clarifications

Sherman "Rhino" (Card # 26)

The reduction in Terrain Value from 2 to 1 applies to Allied attacks only. Allied Armies defending in Bocage continue to use the Terrain Value of 2.

Bradley Halt Order (Card # 42)

If US 3rd Army is split into its two corps, only retreat XV Corps (if it has reached Le Mans). Otherwise retreat the US 3rd Army marker.

Alençon Counter-Attack (Card # 46)

If there are no panzer divisions or *kampfgruppen* on the board, or if 3rd Army has not yet been activated when this card is played, ignore its instructions.

Hitler Intervention Cards

When the player draws a *Hitler Intervention* card he may make a Hitler Approval Check in order to attempt to cancel its effects. If the roll passes, ignore the card. **Exception: Card #32 Mortain Counter-Attack.** This roll -or the decision to go with the intervention- should be made at the start of the Actions Phase.

If intervention goes ahead, the player must move the number of panzer divisions listed (according to the instructions on the card) and then attack the target given on the card. The redeployed panzer unit(s) **must** participate in the attack. These units can be moved from anywhere on the map and/or Strategic Reserve box at no [Action] cost. If these moves would cause a violation of stacking rules then move fewer units as appropriate.

The player may instead choose to implement the instructions on the card in which case no Hitler Approval Check is made.

If moving panzer units would break stacking rules, do not move the units, but attack with as many panzer units as are in the space. All *nebelwerfer* units in the space must attack in addition to designated panzer units.

No Transport Check is needed for this redeployment, but 1 supply point is expended for the attack as normal.

If a Hitler Intervention card calls for an attack on an Allied army besieging a Fortress (not *Fortified Villages* space), ignore the Hitler Intervention (since units cannot be redeployed into those spaces). Any resources gained by the card are still allocated.

If the attack succeeds, increase Hitler Approval by one as for normal attacks. See examples:



In this example, Card 36 was drawn. After the weather roll, the First Canadian Army gets a +1 modifier from the Jabos marker. Let's assume the Canadian attack on Bourguébus Ridge failed. After applying the increase from the card, the Hitler Approval level is at 2. The Hitler Approval

The map shows the Normandy region during the Battle of Normandy. Key locations and units are marked:

- Caen:** A red-bordered card with a black cross symbol, a photograph of the city, and a red circle with the number 4. A yellow box with the letter 'F' is in the bottom left.
- Cagney:** A red-bordered card with a photograph of the town, a red circle with the number 3, and a yellow box with the letter 'T'. Overlaid on this card is a blue-bordered card for the **FIRST CANADIAN ARM** (featuring a Canadian flag and a tank) with a red circle with the number 4 and a yellow box with the letter 'JABOS'. To its right is a blue-bordered card for **JABOS** (featuring a tank) with a red circle with the number +1.
- Falaise Gap:** A grey-bordered card at the bottom center.
- 9th SS PANZER:** A blue-bordered card with a photograph of a tank, a red circle with the number +2, and a yellow box with the letter 'H'.
- 116th PANZER:** A blue-bordered card with a photograph of a tank, a red circle with the number +1, and a yellow box with the letter 'H'.
- Nebelwerfer:** A green-bordered card with a photograph of a rocket launcher, a red circle with the number +1, and a yellow box with the letter 'H'.
- Other locations:** **ers-Bocage** (blue-bordered card with a photograph and a red circle with the number 3), **Falaise Gap** (grey-bordered card), and **Falaise Gap** (grey-bordered card).



The Attack Strength is +5; the Defense Strength is 6. The player rolls a 2 resulting in a victory; the German forces advance to Cagney; the Canadian army retreats, the Supply level is reduced by 1 and the Hitler Approval level increases to 3.

HOUSEKEEPING

During this Phase, certain procedural steps are performed in the order listed below before either the game ends or is continued to the next turn.

If an Allied unit occupies the 0 space on its track – OR – Hitler Approval has reached -2 the game ends immediately in defeat.

Victory

33

FALAISE GAP SCENARIO

This learning scenario gives a quick game which can be used to learn the core concepts in the game. It uses only the third deck of cards. With only 12 cards, it is playable in about 30 minutes.

Follow these steps to set up the game:

1. Place the US 1st Army (strength 4) in the Mortain (3) space.
 2. Place the US XV Corps (strength 2) in the Le Mans (3) space.
 3. Place the US VIII Corps (strength 2) in the Brest (4) space.
 4. Place the British 2nd Army (strength 4) in the Mont Pinçon (2) space.
 5. Place the 1st Canadian Army (strength 4) in the Bourguébus Ridge (2) space.
- Reinforcements are at level "3"
 - Supply is at level "2"
 - Hitler Approval is at level "3" (Base Level is 4, Assassination Attempt has occurred)

German Start Forces

1. Place one full strength 88mm FlaK plus one Nebelwerfer in Vire
2. Place 2nd Panzer Division (reduced) plus one full strength Flak 88 unit in Falaise
3. Place 1st SS Panzer Division (reduced) plus one full strength Flak 88 plus one *Nebelwerfer* in Chambois
4. Place 116th Panzer Division (reduced) plus one full strength Flak 88 unit in Argentan
5. Place two Nebelwerfer units in Alençon

Bocage Terrain Value is 1. Model cannot be placed on the map until Card 38 *Model Takes Command* is drawn.

Shuffle the Late Deck and place in the Draw Pile.



Falaise Scenario Set-Up

Optional Rules

1. This rule supposes the Germans had followed Rommel's advice to position Panzer forces near the coast. Panzer Lehr starts the game in Carentan; 12SS Panzer starts in Lebiey Wood.
2. This rule supposes the Germans used V1 flying bomb to attack the beachhead. +2 Strength Modifier in any Counter-Attack vs any Allied Army when Card 10 *V1 Rockets* is drawn.
3. Early Patton Activation. Activate Patton's 3rd US Army when the 1st US Army captures Cherbourg instead of Avranches.